

Cultural and Ethnic Considerations

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Chapter 6: four ideas to connect

Health beliefs

Explore how background and experience may shape practices, decisions, communication, and trust.

Cultural humility

Use self-awareness and respectful questions instead of assumptions about a group.

Language access

Use qualified interpreters, plain language, and teach-back to support participation.

Individualized care

Adapt care safely, protect dignity, and include patient preferences and support persons.

Put the chapter into safe practical nursing care

Respectful care starts with curiosity—not assumptions.

Ask what matters to the individual patient, explain before touching, and protect privacy and dignity. Use qualified language assistance and work with the team to adapt care safely.

- ✓ Ask about preferences
- ✓ Examine your assumptions
- ✓ Use a qualified interpreter
- ✓ Protect dignity and privacy
- ✓ Confirm understanding

RECOGNIZE → ACT → REPORT

Ask with respect.
Adapt the care.
Confirm the plan.

Before moving on, explain the cue, your immediate action within scope, and the facts you would report.